## Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/ianhogarth (LinkedIn)
Songkick.com (Company)
www.twitter.com/soundboy (Other)
soundboy.tumblr.com (Blog)


## Top Skills

Mobile Devices
Digital Marketing
Start-ups

## Languages

mandarin

## Honors-Awards

Inc. Magazine 30 under 30
Forbes 30 under 30
UK Young Music Entrepreneur of the Year
Billboard 30 under 30
MediaGuardian 100

# Ian Hogarth


founder and investor
London, England, United Kingdom


## Experience

### Plural
Partner
August 2021 - Present (5 years)

Plural is an early-stage investment fund that backs the most ambitious founders on a mission to change the world through technology. Our aim is to have GDP-level impact on Europe, address systemic risks and reduce the opportunity gap worldwide through the companies we back.

### UK AI Safety Institute
Chair
June 2023 - Present (3 years 2 months)

I was appointed in June 2023 reporting directly to the Prime Minister and Technology Secretary. The AI Safety Institute is the first state-backed organisation focused on advanced AI safety for the public interest. Its mission is to minimise surprise to the UK and humanity from rapid and unexpected advances in AI. It will work towards this by developing the sociotechnical infrastructure needed to understand the risks of advanced AI and enable its governance. This is a part-time and unpaid role.

### various
Angel investor
June 2013 - December 2021 (8 years 7 months)

investor in 100+ start-ups including: Academia.edu, Anthropic, Avidbots, Chorus.ai, Cleo, ComplyAdvantage, Cuvva, Disperse, Faculty, Helsing, Hopin, Incident.io, Kheiron Medical, LabGenius, Nested, Omnipresent, PostEra, Rossum, Second Nature, Tide Banking.

### Songkick.com
10 years 5 months

Chairman
December 2015 - July 2017 (1 year 8 months)

http://soundboy.tumblr.com/post/136337729790/new-year-new-roles

Co CEO

June 2015 - December 2015 (7 months)

http://blog.songkick.com/2015/06/04/songkick-crowdsurge/

Crash course in M&A! Very interesting and challenging to take two fast growing start-ups and combine their strategies, cultures, products, orgs. Really rewarding to see it all come together and speed up.

http://blog.songkick.com/2015/12/17/songkick-triples-sales-in-europe-post-merger-raises-another-10m/

### CEO

March 2007 - May 2015 (8 years 3 months)

Co-founded Songkick when I was 25 with the two smartest and highest integrity people I knew (Michelle You & Pete Smith) & was CEO for next 8+ years. We hired & retained an incredible team who:

- built the most comprehensive database of concerts in the entire world
- developed the top rated Songkick web & mobile apps, used by music fans to discover concerts and buy tickets
- unlocked various organic growth channels that scaled those apps to over 10 million monthly uniques
- closed distribution deals with Spotify, MTV, Pitchfork, YouTube, SoundCloud etc
- got us covered by NYT, FT, LA Times, WSJ, TechCrunch, CNBC, Billboard, Recode etc
- grew ticket sales to over $100m, selling tickets for one in every 3 shows in London
- tried some crazy experiments that were too early for their time, but I still believe...like Detour: http://www.nytimes.com/2012/10/23/arts/music/want-andrew-bird-in-your-town-try-crowdfunding.html?_r=0
- raised capital from world class investors including Y Combinator, Index Ventures, Sequoia Capital (first ever London investment), Access Industries

I’m proudest of the team & culture we built during this period and expect many people from that team to go on to start enduring companies of their own.

## Bain & Company

### Associate Consultant

June 2006 - February 2007 (9 months)

Mostly working with tech companies. Based in Asia and Silicon Valley.

Cambridge Consultants Ltd

Software Engineer (Technology Scholar)

September 2000 - August 2005 (5 years)

Writing software. Sponsored through university as part of the Technology Scholarship scheme.

## Education

### Tsinghua University

Mandarin Chinese · (2005 - 2006)

### University of Cambridge

MEng, Machine Intelligence · (2004 - 2005)

### University of Cambridge

BEng, Information Engineering · (2001 - 2004)

### Beijing Language and Culture University

Mandarin Chinese · (2001 - 2001)